KIMODO-POLICY: FROM TEXT-TO-MOTION GENERATORS TO HUMANOID VISION-LANGUAGE-ACTION POLICIES

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Paper under double-blind review



Figure 1: **Overview of Kimodo-Policy.** Top: diverse VLA pretraining adapts T2M priors through three-stage root–body–hand generation for visually grounded control. Bottom: skeletal history conditions action-chunk prediction; real-world examples illustrate coordinated whole-body execution.

ABSTRACT

Humanoid vision–language–action (VLA) models translate multimodal task understanding into coordinated whole-body behavior. Existing approaches equip pretrained vision–language or video generation backbones with action experts, but their pretraining does not directly establish whole-body motion priors. Unified or upper–lower-body action designs also lack dedicated root, body, and hand modeling despite their distinct requirements. These limitations increase the burden of learning precise, coordinated actions from limited task-specific humanoid demonstrations. We introduce Kimodo-Policy, which initializes visually grounded control with pretrained text-to-motion (T2M) priors over inter-joint coordination and temporal structure. Its three-stage root–body–hand architecture combines dedicated generators with explicit dependencies: root trajectories condition body generation, while future body features and visual observations guide hand control. We pretrain the policy on diverse humanoid demonstrations, conditioning actions on visual observations, language instructions, and motion history. With 678M total and only 92M trainable parameters, Kimodo-Policy achieves strong performance on HumanoidArena, SIMPLE, and real-world loco-manipulation tasks. Further experiments show performance gains from larger VLA pretraining datasets, greater model capacity, and stronger pretrained T2M priors.

1 INTRODUCTION

Vision–language–action (VLA) models integrate visual perception, language understanding, and action generation across manipulation tasks and robot embodiments (Brohan et al., 2023; Kim et al., 2024; Black et al., 2025b; Wang et al., 2026b; 2025). Learning instruction-conditioned behaviors from demonstrations provides a unified mapping from multimodal inputs to robot actions. Extending VLA learning to humanoids could broaden task coverage in human environments, where locomotion, posture, and manipulation must be coordinated (Bjorck et al., 2025; Wei et al., 2026a; Hu et al., 2026). For example, transferring objects between tables requires grasping, turning, walking, and placement while maintaining balance (Fig. 1, bottom). Such tasks require grounding task intent and visual feedback in coherent whole-body actions, motivating the extension of robot policy architectures to humanoid loco-manipulation.

Humanoid policy learning commonly extends the backbone–action expert paradigm from manipulation to whole-body control. Pretrained vision–language models encode instruction and observation semantics (Fig. 2(a)) (Bjorck et al., 2025; Wei et al., 2026a; Hu et al., 2026), while video generators supply spatiotemporal priors for scene evolution (Fig. 2(b)) (Zheng et al., 2026; Li et al., 2026). These representations condition action generation across root, body, and hand motion. Unified predictors generate whole-body sequences (Fig. 2(d)) (Hu et al., 2026; Zheng et al., 2026); hybrid designs combine upper-body joint targets with lower-body locomotion commands executed by dedicated controllers (Fig. 2(e)) (Zhong et al., 2025; Jiang et al., 2025). The former captures cross-component dependencies; the latter couples upper-body control with learned locomotion and stabilization. Both transfer pretrained semantic and visual dynamics knowledge to humanoid loco-manipulation.

Despite these advances, two challenges remain. ❶ **Insufficient Whole-Body Motion Priors.** Compared with fixed-base manipulation, humanoid control requires higher-dimensional inter-joint and temporal coordination. Backbone pretraining (Bjorck et al., 2025; Wei et al., 2026a; Zheng et al., 2026; Li et al., 2026) does not directly equip action generators with priors aligned with target humanoid kinematics, leaving them to learn these priors, often from limited task-specific demonstrations. ❷ **Insufficient Differentiation of Motion Components.** Root, body, and hand control differ in scale and precision. Unified prediction (Hu et al., 2026; Zheng et al., 2026) may create competing objectives; hybrid execution (Zhong et al., 2025; Jiang et al., 2025) does not itself provide dedicated root, body, and hand generators. Both must accommodate component-specific requirements while maintaining whole-body coordination.

Recent text-to-motion (T2M) methods learn structured motion distributions conditioned on text or spatial constraints (Petrovich et al., 2022; Tevet et al., 2023; Chen et al., 2023; Zhang et al., 2023a; Guo et al., 2024; Xie et al., 2024). Building on these advances, **Kimodo-Policy** combines a pre-



Figure 2: **Comparison of Humanoid Policy Architectures.** Panels (a)–(c) contrast VLM-based, VGM-based, and our T2M-based policy backbones. Panels (d)–(f) illustrate unified whole-body generation, hybrid generation of upper-body joint targets and lower-body locomotion commands, and our hierarchical root–body–hand generation, respectively.

trained T2M backbone with three-stage root–body–hand generation for humanoid VLA control. ❶ **Strong Whole-Body Motion Priors.** We transfer Kimodo's pretrained inter-joint and temporal priors to high-dimensional, visually grounded control (Fig. 2(c)) (Rempe et al., 2026), easing motion learning from limited task-specific humanoid demonstrations. ❷ **Strong Component-Specific Motion Modeling.** Dedicated generators (Fig. 2(f)) predict root translation and heading, root-conditioned body motion, and hand controls conditioned on future body features and visual observations. Their dependencies support component specialization and whole-body coordination. We pretrain on diverse humanoid demonstrations to generate actions conditioned on visual observations, language instructions, and motion history. With 678M total and only 92M trainable parameters, Kimodo-Policy shows consistent gains from more VLA pretraining data, larger models, and stronger T2M priors. Our main contributions are:

- We introduce **Kimodo-Policy**, a humanoid VLA framework transferring pretrained T2M priors to whole-body control. Pretraining on diverse humanoid demonstrations conditions closed-loop actions on visual observations, language instructions, and motion history.
- We propose dedicated root, body, and hand generators in a three-stage architecture to meet distinct control requirements. Explicit cross-stage conditioning preserves motion dependencies, supporting specialized motion generation and coordinated whole-body control.
- We demonstrate strong performance on HumanoidArena, SIMPLE, and real-world humanoid tasks using 678M parameters (only 92M trainable), with consistent gains from larger VLA pretraining datasets, greater model capacity, and stronger T2M priors.

2 Related Work

2.1 Humanoid Vision-Language-Action Models

Humanoid VLA models typically use pretrained vision–language models (VLMs) or video generation models (VGMs). VLM-based methods transfer visual-semantic knowledge to actions (Bjorck et al., 2025; Wei et al., 2026a; Zhong et al., 2025; Hu et al., 2026): GR00T N1 (Bjorck et al., 2025) couples a VLM with a diffusion action model, while Ψ_0 (Wei et al., 2026a) transfers representations from human egocentric demonstrations to a humanoid action expert. VGM-based methods exploit visual dynamics priors (Zheng et al., 2026; Li et al., 2026): MotionWAM (Zheng et al., 2026) generates whole-body motion from intermediate video features; WholeBodyWAM (Li et al., 2026) grounds world–action priors in whole-body controllers. Unified generators (Hu et al., 2026; Zheng et al., 2026) share prediction across motion components; hybrids (Zhong et al., 2025; Jiang et al., 2025) combine upper-body targets with locomotion commands. HAF (Gu et al., 2026) stages generation with a shared action expert, expanding the active action set and refining earlier predictions. Kimodo-Policy instead transfers a T2M backbone with pretrained inter-joint and temporal priors, reducing the need to learn motion regularities from humanoid demonstrations. Dedicated root, body, and hand generators meet distinct control requirements, while cross-stage conditioning supports coordinated, visually grounded whole-body behavior.

2.2 Text-to-Motion (T2M)

T2M includes TEMOS's variational language–motion modeling (Petrovich et al., 2022), pose-space MDM (Tevet et al., 2023) and latent-space MLD (Chen et al., 2023) diffusion, and autoregressive T2M-GPT (Zhang et al., 2023a) and masked MoMask (Guo et al., 2024) quantized token generation. OmniControl (Xie et al., 2024) adds spatial constraints; Kimodo (Rempe et al., 2026) trains controllable root–body diffusion hierarchies at scale for human and humanoid skeletons. Humanoid-VLA (Ding et al., 2025) and ZeroWBC (Yang et al., 2026) learn autoregressive motion priors in pretrained language models and VLMs, respectively, before visual integration or task adaptation. MotionWAM (Zheng et al., 2026) adapts a pretrained video world model via staged video–motion training; WholeBodyWAM (Zhang et al., 2026) integrates a pretrained motion expert with video and action experts. Kimodo-Policy directly reuses a diffusion T2M backbone pretrained at scale in robot kinematic space. Dedicated root–body–hand generators ground inter-joint and temporal priors in vision and motion history for closed-loop loco-manipulation, reducing relearning from robot demonstrations while accommodating distinct control requirements.

3 METHOD: KIMODO-POLICY

Kimodo-Policy adapts Kimodo's pretrained motion prior for visually grounded, closed-loop humanoid control. We describe its root–body–hand architecture and visual conditioning (Sec. 3.1), motion-prior transfer and history-conditioned control (Sec. 3.2), and training and inference (Sec. 3.3). Background on Kimodo and ControlNet is provided in Appendix A.

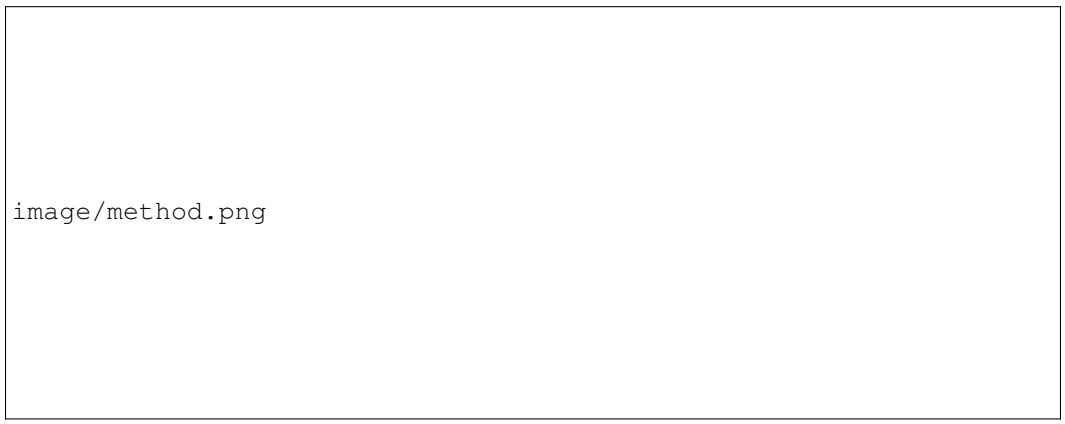


Figure 3: **Kimodo-Policy architecture.** Colored blocks: ▯ Kimodo denoisers, ▯ DINOv3-conditioned (Siméoni et al., 2025) ControlNet, and ▯ HandNet. Dashed boxes show Dual-Path Fusion: motion-query cross-attention and spatial-to-temporal MLPs. Root predictions condition body generation; future body features guide bilateral hand control. The Motion Projector maps root–body outputs to tracker references. Snowflakes/flames mark frozen/trainable modules.

3.1 MODEL ARCHITECTURE

Problem Formulation. We formulate language-conditioned humanoid loco-manipulation as closed-loop prediction of short action chunks. At step k, the policy receives instruction ℓ, the current egocentric RGB image I_k, available motion history $\mathcal{H}_k = [\mathbf{x}_{k-L+1}, \ldots, \mathbf{x}_k]$ in Kimodo's representation, and the current bilateral hand state $\mathbf{s}_k^h$. It predicts a K-frame chunk, with $\mathbf{a}_i = [\mathbf{r}_i, \mathbf{b}_i, \mathbf{h}_i]$ encoding root motion, articulated body motion, and bilateral hand controls:

$$\mathbf{A}_{k+1:k+K} \sim \pi_\theta(\cdot \mid I_k, \ell, \mathcal{H}_k, \mathbf{s}_k^h). \tag{1}$$

Root and body outputs provide kinematic references to a low-level motion tracker (Ze et al., 2025; Guan et al., 2026), while hand outputs specify synchronized binary or continuous closure commands according to the task interface. A chunk prefix is executed before replanning from updated observations, combining visual feedback with temporal context from observed history.

Three-Stage Architecture. As shown in Figure 3, Kimodo-Policy extends Kimodo's (Rempe et al., 2026) pretrained generator with dedicated root, body, and hand stages. LLM2Vec (BehnamGhader et al., 2024) encodes instructions; frozen DINOv3 (Siméoni et al., 2025) extracts visual features. Trainable ControlNet-Root and ControlNet-Body inject these features via Dual-Path Fusion into their corresponding frozen Kimodo denoisers, which also condition on instruction embeddings and motion history. The root stage predicts global translation and heading; their local representation conditions articulated body generation. Trainable HandNet predicts bilateral hand controls from future body features, visual features, and the current bilateral hand state. All root-to-body conditioning is detached, blocking body-stage gradients to Kimodo-Root and ControlNet-Root. HandNet's body and visual inputs are also detached, so hand supervision cannot update Kimodo-Body or either ControlNet branch. These boundaries isolate stage optimization while preserving forward dependencies. Root–body predictions yield whole-body tracking references executed with hand commands.

Dual-Path Fusion. DINOv3 (Siméoni et al., 2025) encodes the current egocentric image into spatial tokens for trainable root and body ControlNet branches. At selected layers of each Kimodo denoiser, future-motion hidden states query these tokens through cross-attention, while a token-axis MLP maps the image-token sequence to the future temporal horizon. Summed outputs pass through a layer-specific zero-initialized projection, producing a residual hint for the corresponding Kimodo layer. Hints are added only to future-motion tokens, leaving the constrained history prefix unchanged. Zero initialization preserves pretrained behavior at adaptation onset; both paths ground the frozen prior through content-selective visual retrieval and temporally aligned conditioning.

HandNet. Hand control specifies opening or closing rather than kinematic pose trajectories, motivating a dedicated bilateral diffusion head. At each denoising step, HandNet jointly processes the current hand state, noisy future hand controls, future body hidden states, and visual tokens to predict two hand-control values per future frame. Conditioning on predicted body features and the current scene aligns hand commands with whole-body action, while the separate head keeps hand labels outside the root–body motion space. It supports binary open/close states and continuous closure changes. During training, body and visual features are detached: hand supervision updates HandNet without gradients to the motion denoiser or ControlNet.

3.2 Adapting Motion Priors for Closed-Loop Control

Motion Prior Transfer. Figure 4 illustrates how a pretrained motion prior supplies temporal structure and whole-body coordination for visually grounded control. Given only "Sit on the sofa," Kimodo (Rempe et al., 2026) generates a coherent sequence ending in a seated posture (top), but lacks grounding in the current scene and robot state. Kimodo-Policy freezes this backbone and injects egocentric visual features through trainable ControlNet branches; motion-history constraints anchor predictions to the ongoing trajectory, enabling the same task from visual observations and state history (bottom). Task-specific learning thus adapts reusable behavior-level structure to the instruction, scene, and state, reducing the need to relearn basic motion patterns from robot demonstrations while preserving coherent closed-loop execution.

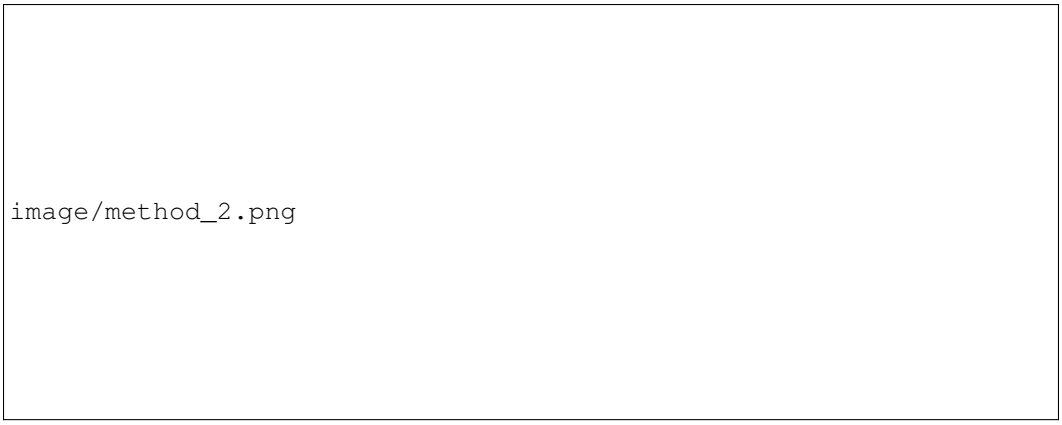


Figure 4: **Motion-Prior Transfer.** Top: frozen Kimodo generates a complete "Sit on the sofa" sequence from text. Bottom: Kimodo-Policy predicts short chunks from vision and motion history for closed-loop control. Light brown: observed history; blue: predicted and executed motion.

Motion-History Conditioning. Fixed T2M sequences cannot respond to deviations between predicted and measured motion or scene changes. We therefore formulate each closed-loop query as constrained motion completion in Kimodo's kinematic representation. Observed history forms the prefix of a history–future window, with feature-wise masks identifying available kinematic values. The prefix is restored before each denoising step; the unconstrained future becomes the next action chunk. Trainable ControlNet branches inject current egocentric image features into Kimodo's root and body denoisers, grounding predictions while retaining the pretrained root–body structure. The tracker executes a chunk prefix; updated history and images condition the next query. This receding-horizon loop preserves the motion prior with continual visual and state-based correction.

3.3 Training and Inference

Training Objective. ControlNet branches and HandNet denoise demonstration windows. At sampled diffusion timesteps, Gaussian noise perturbs normalized root–body features and hand targets; feature-wise masks constrain observed history, with supervision on valid future frames:

$$\mathcal{L} = \lambda_r \mathcal{L}_r + \lambda_b \mathcal{L}_b + \lambda_h \big(\mathcal{L}_h + \lambda_\Delta \mathcal{L}_\Delta\big), \tag{2}$$

The masked MSE terms $\mathcal{L}_r$, $\mathcal{L}_b$, and $\mathcal{L}_h$ reconstruct clean normalized root–body features and hand targets. Binary hand targets use $[-1, 1]$; continuous targets encode closure residuals from the latest valid observed hand state. $\mathcal{L}_\Delta$ computes ℓ_1 error in predicted versus demonstrated consecutive hand-control changes, including the observed-to-first-future transition; continuous residuals are first converted to closure values. All losses mask padding; hand losses also mask unavailable labels, and transitions require two valid adjacent labels. The main MSE weights are $(\lambda_r, \lambda_b, \lambda_h, \lambda_\Delta) = (4, 1, 1, 0.2)$. Predicted root motion and, in the main configuration, root ControlNet features are detached before body generation; HandNet receives detached body and visual features. Kimodo denoisers and the DINOv3 (Siméoni et al., 2025) encoder remain frozen.

Inference. Each policy query encodes the language instruction and current egocentric image, and represents available proprioceptive history in Kimodo's motion space with frame- and feature-wise observation masks. DDIM (Song et al., 2022) iteratively denoises future motion and hand sequences initialized from Gaussian noise. Each step restores observed history, injects visual features into frozen root and body denoisers via ControlNet, conditions body generation on predicted root motion, and predicts hand controls with HandNet using the current hand state, visual features, and future body features. After denoising, we invert the motion representation and map root and joint trajectories, together with bilateral hand commands, to tracker-compatible references. The low-level whole-body tracker executes a chunk prefix; the policy replans from updated images and proprioceptive states, combining structured motion generation with continual closed-loop correction.

4 Experimental Results

We evaluate Kimodo-Policy through single- and multi-task HumanoidArena control (Sec. 4.1), SIMPLE manipulation (Sec. 4.2), and real-world deployment (Sec. 4.3). Analyses cover T2M backbone quality (Sec. 4.4), data and model scaling (Sec. 4.5), and design ablations (Sec. 4.6). Appendix B details the datasets, training protocols, and evaluation environments.

4.1 Evaluation on the HumanoidArena Benchmark

HumanoidArena (Wang et al., 2026a) covers seven language-conditioned tasks spanning human–object interaction (HOI) and human–scene interaction (HSI). We evaluate independent per-task fine-tuning and joint training across SONIC tasks. Appendix C.1 (Fig. 11) visualizes the tasks.

Single-task results. We fine-tune one policy per task with RTC disabled to match baselines. Kimodo-Policy uses direct task fine-tuning; Kimodo-Policy* initializes ControlNet and the hand head from our 419-hour VLA pretraining. Kimodo-Policy achieves the highest overall success rate (SR; 69.51%), exceeding the strongest baseline, DP (Chi et al., 2023) (60.0%), by 9.51 percentage points. It also leads in average HSI SR (84.58%) and ties Kimodo-Policy* for lowest average fall rate (AFR; 4.29%). Kimodo-Policy* achieves 67.14% overall and 84.17% average HSI SR, leading OpenDoor (93.3%) and VisNavi (76.7%). VLA pretraining improves selected tasks, while direct fine-tuning yields higher overall SR.

Table 1: ***Single-task HumanoidArena results.*** A separate policy is fine-tuned per task. For Tables 1–2, values are mean ± standard deviation; * marks VLA-pretrained initialization, and bold/underlined entries mark best/second-best results.

Method	AFR (↓)	Human–Object Interaction				Human–Scene Interaction					Overall (↑)
		Football	DoubleDesk	P&Pbox	Avg (↑)	OpenDoor	SitSofa	Boxing	VisNavi	Avg (↑)	
ACT (Zhao et al., 2023)	8.57%	16.7±6.2%	18.3±4.7%	56.7±6.2%	30.56±19.36%	78.3±9.4%	73.3±8.5%	56.7±6.2%	33.3±2.4%	60.42±18.98%	47.61%
DP (Chi et al., 2023)	8.33%	**45.0±10.8%**	36.7±4.7%	75.0±4.1%	**52.22±17.97%**	85.0±10.8%	78.3±14.3%	**76.7±2.4%**	23.3±6.2%	65.83±26.52%	60%
FM (Lipman et al., 2023)	5.71%	13.3±2.4%	38.3±4.7%	73.3±6.2%	41.67±25.06%	70.0±4.1%	15.0±14.7%	70.0±8.2%	38.3±14.3%	48.33±26.94%	45.46%
$\pi_{0.5}$ (Black et al., 2025a)	5.24%	10.0±4.1%	**43.3±6.2%**	71.7±11.8%	41.67±26.46%	66.7±6.2%	73.3±2.4%	70.0±0.0%	23.3±6.2%	58.33±20.85%	51.19%
Ours	**4.29%**	28.3±6.2%	40.0±0.0%	**80.0±4.1%**	49.44±22.54%	90.0±4.1%	**100.0±0.0%**	73.3±13.1%	75.0±10.8%	**84.58±14.06%**	**69.51%**
Ours*	**4.29%**	26.7±4.7%	28.3±2.4%	78.3±8.5%	44.44±24.66%	**93.3±2.4%**	96.7±2.4%	70.0±8.2%	**76.7±18.9%**	84.17±15.25%	67.14%

Multi-task results. We jointly train one policy on all seven HumanoidArena tasks and evaluate under SONIC (Wang et al., 2026a; Luo et al., 2026), with RTC disabled to match baselines. Table 2 shows Kimodo-Policy* reaching 72.14% overall SR, exceeding the strongest baseline, $\pi_{0.5}$ (Black et al., 2025a) (53.8%), by 18.33 percentage points, with lowest AFR (4.29%). It leads HOI (56.11%) and HSI (84.17%) averages, P&Pbox (90.0%), OpenDoor (95.0%), SitSofa (96.7%, tied), and VisNavi (76.7%). Without VLA pretraining, Kimodo-Policy reaches 67.63% overall and 51.67% HOI SR; overall SR falls only 1.88 percentage points from single-task training. Thus, a shared policy can retain much of its single-task performance with high success and low fall rates.

Table 2: ***Multi-task HumanoidArena results.*** One policy is jointly trained on all seven tasks.

Method	AFR (↓)	Human–Object Interaction				Human–Scene Interaction					Overall (↑)
		Football	DoubleDesk	P&Pbox	Avg (↑)	OpenDoor	SitSofa	Boxing	VisNavi	Avg (↑)	
ACT (Zhao et al., 2023)	7.4%	20.0±4.1%	30.0±4.1%	60.0±12.2%	36.7±18.7%	58.3±2.4%	21.7±2.4%	58.3±10.3%	28.3±4.7%	41.7±17.8%	39.5%
DP (Chi et al., 2023)	7.1%	**53.3±6.2%**	35.0±10.8%	0.0±0.0%	29.4±23.3%	83.3±6.2%	83.3±4.7%	21.7±30.6%	50.0±14.7%	59.6±31.1%	46.7%
FM (Lipman et al., 2023)	7.1%	21.7±8.5%	20.0±7.1%	0.0±0.0%	13.9±11.7%	76.7±2.4%	48.3±6.2%	18.3±25.9%	38.3±6.2%	45.4±25.1%	31.9%
$\pi_{0.5}$ (Black et al., 2025a)	6.4%	10.0±7.1%	30.0±7.1%	75.0±4.1%	38.3±27.9%	85.0±4.1%	70.0±14.7%	**71.7±12.5%**	35.0±4.1%	65.4±21.1%	53.8%
Ours	5.0%	35.0±7.1%	**40.0±0.0%**	80.0±4.1%	51.7±20.7%	93.3±6.2%	**96.7±4.7%**	66.7±4.7%	61.7±6.2%	79.6±16.5%	67.6%
Ours*	**4.3%**	40.0±4.1%	38.3±2.4%	**90.0±4.1%**	**56.1±24.2%**	**95.0±4.1%**	**96.7±4.7%**	68.3±10.3%	**76.7±8.5%**	**84.2±14.1%**	**72.1%**

Attention map analysis. Figure 5 shows Kimodo-Policy focusing on the ball in Football, box in P&P Box, and punching bag in Boxing, alongside relevant scene elements for door opening, sitting, and navigation. $\pi_{0.5}$ responds less locally, while Diffusion Policy activates broader scene regions. This task-dependent focus suggests alignment with instruction semantics and use of task-relevant cues for shared multi-task action selection.

image/attention.pdf

Figure 5: **Task-Conditioned Visual Attention.** Columns show seven HumanoidArena tasks; rows (top to bottom) show $\pi_{0.5}$, Diffusion Policy, and Kimodo-Policy. Kimodo-Policy shifts attention toward task-relevant objects and interaction regions.

4.2 Evaluation on the Simple Benchmark

We further evaluate Kimodo-Policy on the SIMPLE benchmark (Wei et al., 2026b), using the L0–L2 protocol with progressively stronger visual, lighting, and target-pose randomization (Wei et al., 2026b). We fine-tune an independent policy for each of the eight benchmark tasks and report the results in Table 3. This protocol isolates skill acquisition while testing robustness under increasing distribution shifts. See Appendix C.2 (Fig. 12) for task visualizations.

Single-task results. Table 3 evaluates VLA-pretrained Kimodo-Policy (Ours*) on eight SIMPLE tasks, aggregating L0–L2 success rates with RTC disabled to match the baselines. It achieves best or joint-best results on six tasks: Handover (83% vs. 80% for the strongest baseline), Mobile P&P (70% vs. 60%), OpenOven (57% vs. 53%), OpenFaucet (53% vs. 33%), CloseDoor and Push Office Chair (both 100%, tied with Ψ_0). It ranks second on XMoveBendPick (80% vs. 93% for Ψ_0) and OpenTrashCan (63% vs. 83%). These results show that the motion-prior-based, visually grounded root–body–hand policy supports handover, mobile manipulation, articulated-object interaction, and pushing under visual, lighting, and target-pose variation.

Table 3: ***Single-Task Results on SIMPLE.*** L0–L2 progressively increase visual and lighting variation and target-pose randomization. Entries report L0/L1/L2 success counts and aggregate success rates (parentheses); bold/underlined values mark the best/second-best aggregate rates.

Method	HANDOVER	MOBILE P&P	XMOVEBENDPICK	CLOSEDOOR	OPENOVEN	OPENFAUCET	PUSH OFFICE CHAIR	OPENTRASHCAN
Ψ_0 (Wei et al., 2026a)	7/7/10 (80%)	7/5/6 (60%)	**10/9/9 (93%)**	**10/10/10 (100%)**	7/5/4 (53%)	3/3/4 (33%)	**10/10/10 (100%)**	**7/9/9 (83%)**
Ours*	**9/8/8 (83%)**	**9/8/4 (70.0%)**	10/7/7 (80%)	**10/10/10 (100%)**	**8/4/5 (57%)**	**5/6/5 (53%)**	**10/10/10 (100%)**	9/4/6 (63%)

4.3 EVALUATION ON THE REAL-WORLD HUMANOID ROBOT

We test a physical humanoid on eight language-conditioned loco-manipulation tasks under unconstrained sensing and execution, covering locomotion, balance, single- and dual-arm coordination, and contact-rich manipulation. Each task has ten trials scored by successful completions; Appendix C.3 (Fig. 13) provides visualizations.

Real-world results. Scratch-trained Kimodo-Policy averages 45% success, above GR00T N1.6 (Bjorck et al., 2025) (31%) and Ψ_0 (Wei et al., 2026a) (35%; Fig. 6). VLA pretraining raises this to 60% (+15 points), improving seven tasks and matching Cart Pushing (60%). Its strongest results are Punching Bag (90%), Cushion Sitting (80%), and Dual-Arm PNP (70%), supporting pretraining for real-world adaptation.

image/real_world_success_rates.png

Figure 6: **Real-World Success Rates.** GR00T N1.6, Ψ_0, and Kimodo-Policy with/without VLA pretraining are compared on eight tasks; the rightmost group reports mean success.

4.4 DOES BETTER T2M IMPROVE VLA PERFORMANCE?

To test motion-prior quality, we compare Kimodo-G1-SEED-v1 and RP-v1 T2M backbones (Rempe et al., 2026) under identical policy architectures, adaptation procedures, and HumanoidArena protocols. Both have 282M parameters and 90%/10% train/test splits; SEED-v1 uses 288 h of BONES-SEED data and RP-v1 uses 700 h of Rigplay (Rempe et al., 2026).

Table 4: ***Effect of the T2M backbone on Kimodo-Policy.*** We compare two same-size Kimodo-G1 backbones using the same adaptation protocol. Data scales include the training and test splits; results are mean $\pm$ standard deviation over three seeds.

Base Model	Model Size	Data Scale	Human–Object Interaction			Human–Scene Interaction				Overall (↑)
			FOOTBALL	DOUBLEDESK	P&PBOX	OPENDOOR	SITSOFA	BOXING	VISNAVI	
Kimodo-G1-SEED-v1	282 M	288 h	**50.00±16.33%**	33.33±15.46%	75.00±10.80%	60.00±4.08%	90.00±4.08%	**71.67±8.50%**	**70.00±18.71%**	64.29%
Kimodo-G1-RP-v1	282 M	700 h	35.0±7.1%	**40.0±0.0%**	**80.0±4.1%**	**93.3±6.2%**	**96.7±4.7%**	66.7±4.7%	61.7±6.2%	**67.63%**

T2M transfer results. RP-v1 improves overall SR over SEED-v1 from 64.29% to 67.63% (+3.34 points; Table 4), with gains on DoubleDesk (33.33% $\rightarrow$ 40.0%), P&Pbox (75.0% $\rightarrow$ 80.0%), OpenDoor (60.0% $\rightarrow$ 93.3%), and SitSofa (90.0% $\rightarrow$ 96.7%), but declines on Football (50.0% $\rightarrow$ 35.0%), Boxing (71.67% $\rightarrow$ 66.7%), and VisNavi (70.0% $\rightarrow$ 61.7%). Under the fixed architecture and training protocol, stronger priors yield gains concentrated in human–scene interaction, with task-dependent trade-offs.

4.5 Does Performance Scale with Data and Model Size?

We vary VLA policy-pretraining data duration with the architecture, SonicX7 adaptation, and evaluation fixed, then vary active policy parameters with the pretrained T2M backbone, downstream data, optimization, and evaluation fixed. RTC is disabled throughout to match the benchmark protocol.



Figure 7: Scaling behavior of Kimodo-Policy. Left: overall success rate as a function of VLA policy-pretraining data duration. Right: overall success rate as a function of active policy parameters.

Data scaling results. Overall success rises from 68.10% with 105 h to 69.05% with 210 h and 72.14% with 419 h of VLA pretraining data, a 4.04-point gain (Fig. 7).

Model scaling results. Increasing active policy parameters from 53.6M to 91.7M and 158.9M raises overall success from 61.43% to 67.63% and 68.57%, respectively, a 7.14-point gain that supports scaling policy capacity.

4.6 Ablation Study

All ablations train on mixed HumanoidArena tasks in SONIC X7 and evaluate on DoubleDesk, Football, and P&Pbox. Figure 8 reports training loss and mean success across these tasks.



Figure 8: **Training Dynamics and Ablation Performance.** Left: training loss for trained and no-training settings. Right: mean success on DoubleDesk, Football, and P&Pbox. Gray bars show component and training-design ablations; light blue (w/o Pretrain) and dark blue (Ours*) compare VLA pretraining.

Results Analysis. Without VLA pretraining, Kimodo-Policy achieves 51.67% mean success; removing the T2M backbone, unfreezing it, replacing MSE with Kimodo's original motion objective, or removing root–body gradient detachment yields 18.33%, 31.67%, 35.00%, or 45.00%, respectively. These results support a frozen motion prior, MSE supervision, and gradient separation. VLA pretraining raises success from 51.67% to 56.11%, with generally lower and less variable training loss. Both compared variants retain the T2M backbone, showing that VLA pretraining complements the motion prior.

5 CONCLUSION

We presented Kimodo-Policy, which transfers pretrained text-to-motion priors to visually grounded, closed-loop humanoid control. Experiments on HumanoidArena, SIMPLE, and eight real-world tasks demonstrate strong performance with 92M trainable parameters out of 678M total. Stronger T2M backbones, larger VLA pretraining datasets, and increased policy capacity improve performance within the evaluated settings, supporting motion generation as a foundation for humanoid VLA learning. The framework relies on SONIC, with cross-tracker transfer unverified; Appendix **??** details this limitation and future directions toward broader controller compatibility, multimodal integration, and stronger motion priors.

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A PRELIMINARIES

This section reviews the two foundations of Kimodo-Policy. We first summarize Kimodo's hierarchical text-to-motion formulation and kinematic representation (Sec. A.1), and then introduce ControlNet and its parameter-efficient mechanism for injecting additional conditions into a frozen diffusion backbone (Sec. A.2).

A.1 KIMODO

Architecture Overview. Kimodo (Rempe et al., 2026) is a framework for controllable kinematic motion generation based on diffusion, with pretrained models for both the SOMA (Saito et al., 2026) human skeleton and the Unitree G1 humanoid robot. Starting from Gaussian noise, it generates motion sequences conditioned on text prompts and optional kinematic constraints using a two-stage Transformer denoiser operating on pose tokens. At each diffusion step t, its input–output mapping is summarized as

$$\widehat{\mathbf{X}}_0 = \mathcal{D}_\theta(\mathbf{X}_t, c, t) = [\widehat{\mathbf{R}}_0, \widehat{\mathbf{B}}_0]. \tag{3}$$

Here, $\mathbf{X}_t$ is the noisy motion, c collects the text and motion conditions, and $\widehat{\mathbf{R}}_0$ and $\widehat{\mathbf{B}}_0$ are the predicted clean root and body motions. The denoiser first predicts the global root motion, then uses its local representation to condition body prediction. Text embeddings provide semantic guidance, while masked motion constraints support control through keyframes, joint positions and orientations, and root waypoints or paths. In this work, we primarily use the Kimodo-G1 motion generation model as our pretrained backbone, which is trained on human motion-capture data retargeted to the G1 skeleton using the SOMA retargeter to enable direct generation of kinematic robot motions.

Motion Representation. Kimodo (Rempe et al., 2026) encodes a motion sequence as $\mathbf{X} = [\mathbf{x}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{x}_N]$ for N frames, with the root at the first frame centered horizontally at the origin. For a skeleton with J joints, each frame contains six groups of kinematic features:

$$\mathbf{x}_n = [\mathbf{r}_n^p, \mathbf{r}_n^a, \mathbf{j}_n^p, \mathbf{j}_n^v, \mathbf{j}_n^a, \mathbf{f}_n] \in \mathbb{R}^{12J+9}. \tag{4}$$

Here, $\mathbf{r}_n^p \in \mathbb{R}^3$ is the global root position obtained by smoothing the horizontal (x, z) coordinates of the pelvis while preserving its vertical height, and $\mathbf{r}_n^a = [\cos\psi_n, \sin\psi_n] \in \mathbb{R}^2$ encodes the global heading angle ψ_n. Joint positions $\mathbf{j}_n^p \in \mathbb{R}^{3J}$ use horizontal offsets from the smoothed root and absolute vertical coordinates, with axes aligned to the world frame. Joint velocities $\mathbf{j}_n^v \in \mathbb{R}^{3J}$ are computed from global joint positions, and joint rotations $\mathbf{j}_n^a \in \mathbb{R}^{6J}$ encode each joint's global orientation using a continuous 6D representation. The binary vector $\mathbf{f}_n \in \{0, 1\}^4$ records contact states for the left heel, left toe, right heel, and right toe. These features form a root component $\mathbf{r}_n^{\text{glob}} = [\mathbf{r}_n^p, \mathbf{r}_n^a]$ and a body component $\mathbf{b}_n = [\mathbf{j}_n^p, \mathbf{j}_n^v, \mathbf{j}_n^a, \mathbf{f}_n]$, providing an explicit decomposition for root and body motion prediction while supporting spatial constraints on root trajectories, joint positions, and joint orientations.

A.2 CONTROLNET

Architecture Overview. ControlNet (Zhang et al., 2023b) adapts a pretrained diffusion model to new spatial or semantic conditions while preserving the capabilities acquired by its original backbone. Its central design freezes the pretrained denoiser and adds a trainable control branch with a structurally aligned sequence of layers. The control branch processes the additional condition and produces intermediate features that are injected into the corresponding layers of the frozen branch through zero-initialized projections. For a frozen layer F_ℓ, a trainable control layer $G_{\phi,\ell}$, and condition representation $\mathbf{c}$, the interaction can be written as

$$\mathbf{h}_{\ell+1}^{\text{ctrl}} = G_{\phi,\ell}(\mathbf{h}_\ell^{\text{ctrl}}, \mathbf{c}), \qquad \mathbf{h}_{\ell+1}^{\text{lock}} = F_\ell(\mathbf{h}_\ell^{\text{lock}}) + \mathcal{Z}_\ell\big(\mathbf{h}_{\ell+1}^{\text{ctrl}}\big), \tag{5}$$

where $\mathcal{Z}_\ell$ is a learnable 1×1 projection initialized to zero. At initialization, the residual path therefore contributes no signal and the adapted model exactly follows the pretrained denoiser. During optimization, gradients update only the control branch and zero projections, allowing the model to learn condition-specific behavior while retaining the original generative prior. This structure is particularly useful when the target dataset is limited or when preserving the motion regularities of a pretrained generator is important. In Kimodo-Policy, we adopt this principle for a transformer-based

motion denoiser rather than a convolutional image U-Net (Ronneberger et al., 2015). The frozen Kimodo root and body denoisers provide the motion prior, while trainable ControlNet branches receive visual features and inject residual hints at selected denoising layers. The specific visual encoder, dual-path fusion mechanism, and root/body injection strategy are described in Sec. 3.1.

B Experimental Setup

This section describes the data, training protocols, and evaluation environments used to assess Kimodo-Policy. We first detail VLA policy pretraining on heterogeneous humanoid demonstrations (Sec. B.1), and then describe post-training and evaluation on the HumanoidArena and SIMPLE simulators as well as on a physical humanoid robot (Sec. B.2).

B.1 Pretraining

Dataset. We assemble a 419-hour pretraining corpus from three publicly released humanoid datasets (Fig. 9). HIW-500 provides teleoperated Unitree G1 demonstrations collected in real homes. From UniFoLM-WBT, we use the 14 task-specific G1 subsets available when our corpus was assembled: the BrainCo subsets *Collect Plates into Dishwasher*, *Make the Bed*, *Pick Up Medicine*, and *Pickup Pillow*; the Dex1 subset *Put Clothes into Washing Machine*; and the Inspire subsets *Clean the Living Room*, *Collect Clothes (MainCamOnly)*, *Pick Up Drinks*, *Pickup Pillow (MainCamOnly)*, *Put Clothes into Basket*, *Put Clothes into Washing Machine*, *Put Clothes into Washing Machine (MainCamOnly)*, *Put Drinks into Fridge*, and *Put Vegetables into Basket*. Main-camera-only variants are included when available, while UniFoLM-WBT entries released after this snapshot are excluded. Humanoid Everyday (Zhao et al., 2025) contributes 10.3K trajectories, over three million frames, and 260 tasks spanning dexterous manipulation, articulated-object interaction, human–robot interaction, and locomotion-integrated behaviors. We form training examples from an egocentric image, a language instruction, a 100-frame motion history, and a 50-frame future action chunk sampled at 30 Hz, converting trajectories to Kimodo's motion representation.

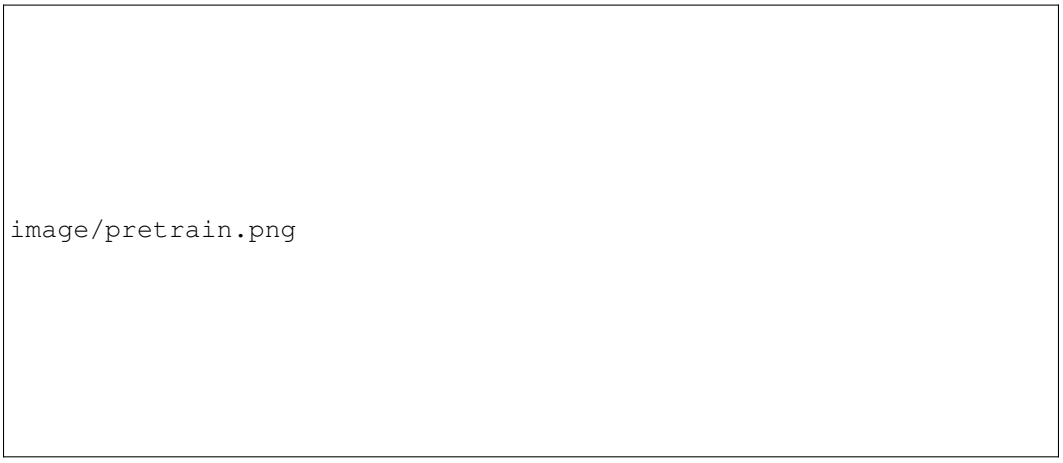


Figure 9: **Composition of the VLA Pretraining Corpus.** The corpus combines HIW-500, 14 task subsets from UniFoLM-WBT available when the corpus was assembled, and Humanoid Everyday. UniFoLM-WBT entries released after corpus construction are excluded.

Implementation Details. We pretrain the policy for 1,000k optimization steps on 16 NVIDIA H200 GPUs, taking approximately 60 hours with bfloat16 mixed precision and a global batch size of 1024. During VLA pretraining, hand supervision is represented as a two-dimensional binary vector indicating the open/closed state of the left and right hands. This shared representation accommodates the different hand morphologies, degrees of freedom, and control conventions in the source datasets, preserving grasp-and-release semantics while providing a consistent target for the hand head. We use AdamW with learning rates of 3×10^{-5} for the ControlNet backbone and 1×10^{-4} for the

ControlNet adapters and hand head, together with a weight decay of 0.01. The learning rate follows a cosine schedule with 1% warm-up and a minimum of 10% of its initial value.

B.2 POST-TRAINING

HumanoidArena Benchmark. HumanoidArena (Wang et al., 2026a; Luo et al., 2026) provides seven leg-critical tasks: three human–object and four human–scene interaction tasks requiring coordinated locomotion, balance, posture adjustment, and manipulation. Its SONIC data contain 100 successful demonstrations per task (700 total) with synchronized egocentric RGB, proprioceptive states, and whole-body targets. We use all seven tasks for single-task fine-tuning and joint multi-task training, the latter being more challenging because one policy must acquire all tasks simultaneously. We evaluate closed-loop performance with SONIC using success rate (SR) and average fall rate (AFR), capturing both task completion and stability during whole-body task execution.

SIMPLE Benchmark. SIMPLE (Wei et al., 2026b) integrates MuJoCo contact dynamics with Isaac Sim rendering for scalable evaluation of humanoid loco-manipulation. The paper describes a benchmark comprising 60 tasks; of these, 18 have been released in the public codebase to date. The paper reports baseline results for six tasks, with two evaluated using AMO and four using the SONIC tracker. From the currently released tasks, we select eight for evaluation: Handover, Mobile P&P, XMoveBendPick, CloseDoor, OpenOven, OpenFaucet, Push Office Chair, and OpenTrashCan. Together, these tasks cover object handover, mobile pick-and-place, articulated-object interaction, and household-object manipulation, allowing us to assess policy robustness and execution stability in contact-rich whole-body control.

Real-World Data Collection and Setup. We collect real-world demonstrations with a teleoperation system implemented on top of and extended from the NVIDIA Isaac-GR00T data-preparation pipeline (Bjorck et al., 2025). As shown on the left of Fig. 10, the operator uses a PICO 4 Ultra headset and hand controllers together with PICO body trackers for whole-body and lower-limb tracking. The humanoid is equipped with an Intel RealSense D435i camera and Dex3-1 dexterous hands. We define eight real-world tasks spanning locomotion, balance, and single- and dual-arm manipulation, and record 25–30 demonstrations per task. The two plots on the right of Fig. 10 show representative joint-position traces from two of these tasks: in Football Scoring (Fig. 10a), the right-leg trajectory changes sharply around the kick, while in Banana Cabinet (Fig. 10b), the traces vary across the pick, place, and push phases. In both plots, solid curves show measured joint positions and dashed curves show the corresponding action commands for the left and right sides, illustrating the task-dependent motion captured in the demonstrations. We store the demonstrations in a LeRobot v2.1 (Cadene et al., 2026)-compatible format, extended with Kimodo-specific motion and control fields for policy training with a motion prior.

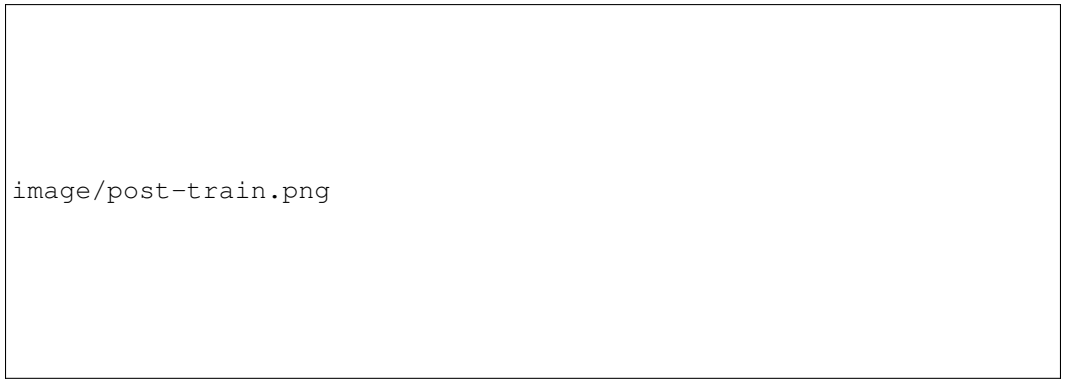


Figure 10: **Real-World Data Collection and Motion Profiles.** Left: PICO-based whole-body teleoperation of the humanoid. Right: measured (solid) and commanded (dashed) left- and right-side mean joint positions for two of the eight physical-robot tasks: (a) Football Scoring, showing a pronounced right-leg change during the kick, and (b) Banana Cabinet, showing motion across the pick, place, and push phases.

Implementation Details. We fine-tune all policies with bfloat16 precision on four GPUs using 30 Hz motion sequences, a 100-frame history, and a 50-frame prediction horizon. HumanoidArena single-task policies use a global batch size of 64 for 200k steps, while the joint seven-task policy uses a batch size of 128 for 500k steps; SIMPLE uses a batch size of 64 for 200k steps, and real-world policies use a batch size of 32 for 50k steps. Scratch-trained and VLA-pretrained variants share the same fine-tuning setup and differ only in initialization. The four-layer ControlNet detaches the root-control input to body prediction. We train with an MSE objective weighted 4, 1, 1, and 0.2 for root motion, body motion, hand control, and hand transitions, respectively, using AdamW (weight decay 0.01) and a cosine schedule with 1% warm-up and a 10% minimum learning-rate ratio. The ControlNet backbone, adapters, and hand head use learning rates of 3×10^{-5}, 1×10^{-4}, and 1×10^{-4} for HumanoidArena and real-world fine-tuning, and 1×10^{-5}, 3×10^{-5}, and 3×10^{-5} for SIMPLE. SIMPLE training uses color jitter and continuous hand-control targets; real-world training uses color jitter and random crops, with binary hand commands conditioned on measured hand closure. At inference, all policies run on one NVIDIA RTX 4090 with 10 diffusion denoising steps and predict a 50-frame action horizon at 30 Hz. We execute 15 predicted frames per policy update on HumanoidArena and the real robot, and either 15 or 50 frames on SIMPLE depending on the evaluation setting. The SONIC tracker runs at 50 Hz; real-time correction (RTC) (Black et al., 2025c) is enabled only for real-world deployment and disabled for HumanoidArena and SIMPLE.

C TASK VISUALIZATIONS

C.1 HUMANOIDARENA TASKS



Figure 11: **Visualization of the Seven HumanoidArena Tasks.** The benchmark includes Football, DoubleDesk, P&Pbox, OpenDoor, SitSofa, Boxing, and VisNavi, covering language-conditioned humanoid behavior across human–object and human–scene interaction with coordinated locomotion, balance, and manipulation.

C.2 SIMPLE TASKS

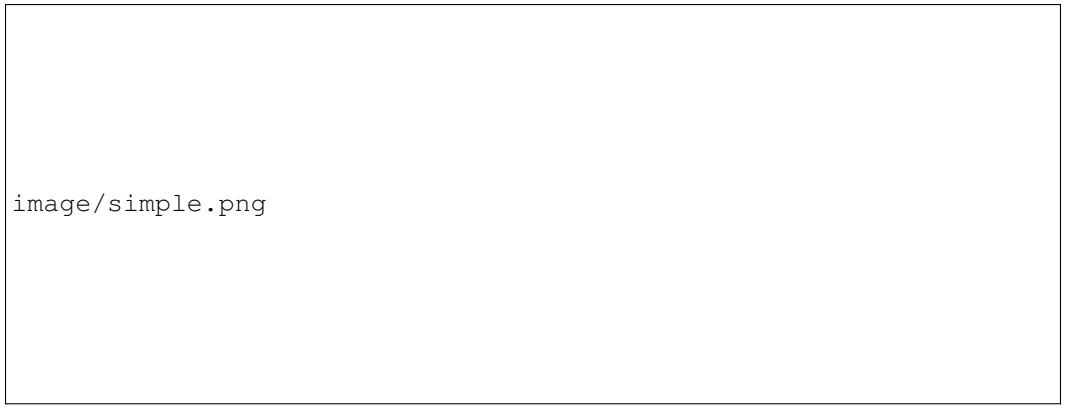


Figure 12: **Evaluated SIMPLE Task Suite.** The selected tasks cover object handover and mobile pick-and-place, locomotion-integrated object pickup, articulated-object interaction, and household-object manipulation. Panels show (a) Handover, (b) Mobile P&P, (c) XMoveBendPick, (d) CloseDoor, (e) OpenOven, (f) OpenFaucet, (g) Push Office Chair, and (h) OpenTrashCan.

C.3 REAL-WORLD TASKS



Figure 13: **Examples of Real-World Humanoid Manipulation.** The image shows representative interaction scenarios involving articulated objects, object transport, and coordinated whole-body motion.

D LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE DIRECTIONS

Limitations. A principal limitation of the current framework is its dependence on a specific low-level motion tracker. Kimodo-Policy is designed and evaluated with SONIC, and its motion-reference interface and deployment pipeline are tailored to this tracker; other tracking controllers are not currently supported. Consequently, the reported results establish the effectiveness of the policy within the SONIC-based control stack, while transfer across trackers remains unverified. Although separating high-level motion generation from low-level execution provides a modular organization, this separation alone does not ensure compatibility with controllers that differ in reference parameterization, tracking behavior, or executable motion range. Extending the framework would therefore require adapting the policy–tracker interface and validating closed-loop performance under the target controller. Developing a more general interface between pretrained motion generation and low-level whole-body control remains an important direction for broadening its applicability.

Future Work. Looking ahead, Kimodo-Policy can be viewed as a motion-prior-informed action expert within a larger multimodal architecture. Integrating it with vision–language models and video generation models, potentially through MoT-style architectures, could combine semantic understanding and visual dynamics modeling with structured whole-body action generation. A complementary direction is to strengthen the underlying motion prior itself. Text–motion supervision can draw on human motion data retargeted to robot embodiments without requiring every sequence to be collected through robot execution with synchronized visual observations, offering a scalable route to motion pretraining. The gains observed with stronger T2M backbones motivate investigating whether broader motion coverage and more capable generators yield further improvements in downstream control. Beyond training robot-space motion models on retargeted data, a longer-term direction is to transfer pretrained human T2M backbones directly into humanoid VLA policies, drawing on the breadth of human motion resources and advances in human motion generation. Such transfer would require aligning motion representations across embodiments and adapting human kinematic priors to robot-specific actuation, balance, and contact constraints. These directions could expand the framework from a standalone policy into a reusable motion-generation component for more capable humanoid systems.